

Treatment and Emergency Recommendations for Methylmalonic Acidemia

Patient:

DOB:

MBR#:

Definition: Methylmalonic acidemia is an inherited disorder of organic acid metabolism. Persons with this condition can appear normal; but if challenged with high protein diet or physiological stress (infections, etc.); the individual can have a metabolic decompensation.

Signs of decompensations: Irritability, tachypnea, lethargy, vomiting, coma and death.

Treatments: Dietary restriction of protein, the use of supplemental carnitine, avoidance of fasting.

Treatment during illness:

- IV fluids – D10/ ½ normal saline to keep blood glucose > 120.
- L-carnitine 100 mg/kg in D10 IV over 2 hours (loading dose)
(Start D10/ ½ NS immediately before labs are done)
(Continue L-carnitine 100 mg/kg/24 hours in divided doses)
(L-carnitine for IV use comes in 1000 mg/5 ml vials)
(Add calories to IV fluids as indicated)
- Lab tests: Plasma ammonia, CMP, CBC
- Withhold protein feeding, oral carbohydrates ad lib as tolerated. Continue oral carnitine if possible.
- Sodium bicarbonate as indicated for acidosis.

Notification: Please notify the metabolic specialist immediately (after business hours this number allows you to speak with the geneticist on call):

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(After Hours: Please call 1-800-888-5533)